

Question:
At birth, the least developed part of the brain is the

Answer Choices:

- A. visual system
- B. thalamus
- C. frontal lobe
- D. brain stem
- E. parietal lobe
- F. cerebellum
- G. cortex
- H. basal ganglia
- I. hypothalamus
- J. limbic system

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

At birth, the brain is proportionally smaller than at adulthood, and most brain regions are less developed. Although many structures show broad growth and maturation, the least developed in early infancy compared with fully formed structures is the cerebral cortex. Cortical neurons and glial cells continue to proliferate rapidly and expand substantially between birth and the early twenties, and many have slow, prolonged neurogenesis. In contrast, other brain regions (such as the thalamus, basal ganglia, and limbic structures) are relatively well formed at birth, and the brain stem, cerebellum, and parietal lobe also develop early. Because the visual system is also largely formed at birth and many limbic and hypothalamic structures show significant development during the first months, the region that is disproportionately less developed is the cortex. Therefore, the least developed part of the brain at birth is the cortex.

Correct answer: G. cortex

</think>

<answer>

G. cortex

</answer>

